EDU HTML 5 Template Guidelines

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1. Template Basic Info

The template is made using Dreamweaver templates, please watch this youtube video to show you how they work: http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hxor4tkm4i8

Here is another tutorial that shows how the templates were created and will be useful, especially if you want to make changes to the main template.

I suggest you install FireBug for Firefox if you haven't already, as this is the most comprehensive browser development tool.

Main Template

The main template is held in the templates folder, and changes to this file will reflect across all your pages. The template is made up of:

- Editable regions
  - Document Title
  - Head (space incase you'd like additional code in here, css etc)
  - Section Title
  - Main Content Area
  - Progress Bar - pagination that can be shown or hidden, with percentage width bar
  - Bottom (space incase you'd like to additional code in here, for JavaScript etc)
- Editable attributes
  - Page body ID (this is used so that we can target sections (pages and it's sub-pages) in css if we need to without using inline styles or hacks)
  - Back and next button links (which will show on the top, and bottom of every long page)

Edit the Attributes: Modify > Template Properties

To change the editable attributes of a page go to Modify > Template Properties (this should be done for every page, though I suggest at the end so that you have finalised your navigation structure and won't need to change it.).

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2. Getting Started

- Make a copy of the template folder
- Open the library item 'Navigation Menu' and delete all the files (list items) that you are not going to use from the menu, and also from the 'web' folder – or you can keep them for reference and delete them later.
- Edit the page to have your chosen background image

    - Find the ‘backstretch’ code in the editable region ‘bottom’ to have your background
    - Eg. You will want one image as background for each section, or throughout, but you can have a few images on the intro page
- Put content in the editable areas:
    - Page Title
    - Section Title
    - Main Content Area
    - If you are adding additional scripting, you can either put it in the ‘head’ and ‘bottom’ editable areas, or change the main template in the templates folder to include it in all pages if you need it in every page.
- Edit ‘Progress-Bar’ editable region:
    - Add ‘hidden’ class to ‘progess-wrapper’ if you don’t want this bit to to show eg… OR…
    - Edit the text ‘page … of page …’
    - Correct the ‘meter’ width to the correct percentage eg. 10% for page 1 of 10
- Go to ‘Modify’ > ‘Template Properties’ to edit the editable attributes for the page (these are simple links that need updating on every page so they point to the correct place, and this is best done once your page structure has been confirmed.)
    - ‘Back Button Link’ is the name of the page that comes before
    - ‘Next Button Link’ is the name of the page that comes after
    - ‘Section Name’ is the ID that will be associated with that section and it’s sub-pages. This can be used to target a section or sub-sections pages via css. It will come in handy, even though it isn’t used in the example template css itself. (write these down as you implement them for quick reference later.

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3. Editing the Navigation

The navigation structure is held as a library item (you can either find it in window > assets, or it will be in the tab next to ‘Files’ on bottom right corner).

Here is a help file with more information about assets

When you make changes and save it, you will be prompted to update the associated files. (If you choose not to update, it can be done later).

To create sub-pages

If you have navigation with a section that has a sub navigation, then you can create multiple instances of the menu, so that your sub-pages don’t have to show throughout the site. Eg. Create a new instance of the navigation for the page that has sub-pages.

You can do this by:

- Either right-click ‘Navigation Menu’ and select ‘New Library Item’ or select it and then click the icon of the file with a ‘+’ on it.
- Rename it accordingly (probably something like ‘Navigation Menu – Section Name’ is a good idea)
- Double-click ‘Navigation Menu’ to open it for editing
- Copy + paste the navigation from here into the new library item
- The go back to your page and change the editable area ‘navigation’ to link to a different library item

You can also include icons in here, like I have done for the home page and book shelf. You can see how it’s done by looking at the list item for the home page:

Home Page

There is a cheat sheet for the icon font here

(I have noticed that some of the classes specified on their website aren’t working when I’ve tried to use them in the way they say is possible, to get round this I’ve been finding the classes that I am able to use in the css file ‘font-awesome.css’ and using them that way. You can use the Unicode characters as opposed to putting a class on an icon tag though. I’ll post an update when I figure this out.)

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4. Foundation Framework

I have put some links to specific features which I think might be useful to us in the html 5 template, you can see the website with all documentation here: http://foundation.zurb.com/

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5 Explanation of Code Used

5.1 Conditional HTML Classes

```
<!--[if lt IE 7]>      <html class="no-js lt-ie9 lt-ie8 lt-ie7"> <![endif]-->
<!--[if IE 7]>         <html class="no-js lt-ie9 lt-ie8"> <![endif]-->
<!--[if IE 8]>         <html class="no-js lt-ie9"> <![endif]-->
<!--[if gt IE 8]><!--> <html class="no-js"> <!--<![endif]-->
```

A series of IE conditional comments apply the relevant IE-specific classes to the `html` tag. This provides one method of specifying CSS fixes for specific legacy versions of IE.

http://www.paulirish.com/2008/conditional-stylesheets-vs-css-hacks-answer-neither

The ‘no-js’ class

Allows you to more easily explicitly add custom styles when JavaScript is disabled (`no-js`) or enabled (`js`).

5.2 X-UA-Compatible

```
<meta http-equiv="X-UA-Compatible" content="IE=edge">
```

This makes sure the latest version of IE is used in versions of IE that contain multiple rendering engines. Even if a site visitor is using IE8 or IE9, it's possible that they're not using the latest rendering engine their browser contains.

5.3 Viewport and Media Queries

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
```

More info in this presentation

5.4 IE Scripts

```
<!--[if lt IE 7]> <script src="http://ie7-js.googlecode.com/svn/version/2.0(beta3)/IE7.js" type="text/javascript"></script>

        <script src="http://ie7-js.googlecode.com/svn-history/r25/trunk/lib/ie7-squish.js" type="text/javascript"></script><![endif]-->
```

To fix IE6 deficiencies and improve IE7&8 conformance

- Fix IE7 bugs (fixed positioning, min/max width/height, trans pngs '-trans.png', additional selectors)
- Fix other IE7 bugs (peekaboo bug, double margin, unscrollable content)
- http://www.charlescooke.me.uk/web/lab_notes/ie7_script.html

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5.5 HTML 5 Shiv

```
<!--[if lt IE 9]><script src="http://html5shiv.googlecode.com/svn/trunk/html5.js"></script><![endif]-->
```

http://html5shiv.googlecode.com

5.6 Modernizr

```
<script src="js/vendor/modernizr-2.6.2.min.js"></script>
```

Detects html5 and css3 features in a users browser – you can use it to target browsers you're finding quirks with. It adds classes to the html element that explain precisely what features are and are not natively supported, and you can use those classes in your stylesheets to target your 'quirks'.

In general, in order to keep page load times to a minimum, it's best to call any JavaScript at the end of the page because if a script is slow to load from an external server it may cause the whole page to hang. That said, the Modernizr script needs to run before the browser begins rendering the page, so that browsers lacking support for some of the new HTML5 elements are able to handle them properly. Therefore the Modernizr script is the only JavaScript file synchronously loaded at the top of the document.

More information:

- http://webdesignernotebook.com/css/how-to-use-modernizr/
- http://alistapart.com/article/taking-advantage-of-html5-and-css3-with-modernizr
- https://learnable.com/courses/modernizr-front-end-development-done-right-2561
- https://github.com/Modernizr/Modernizr/wiki/HTML5-Cross-Browser-Polyfills]

FYI: I originally used the '.sound' class and then realised it was doing strange things to my layout, then realised it was a class used by Moderizr, so when I used it, it was being applied to my html tag aswell… be careful that the classes that it outputs doesn't interfere with any classes you may introduce. If you use it, it's recommended you create a customized version when you know what features you want to target. More details at the bottom of the following page: http://www.adobe.com/devnet/dreamweaver/articles/using-modernizr.html

You can also test your browser here: http://modernizr.github.io/Modernizr/test/ (this can be used as a list to refer to aswell).

If you don't need to use this at all, you can delete it from the main template file. Or if you're only having problems with IE, consider using IE conditional statements as an alternative: http://reference.sitepoint.com/css/conditionalcomments or http://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/ms537512%28VS.85%29.aspx

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5.7 Normalise

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="css/normalize.css">
```

HTML5-ready alternative to CSS resets. Makes browsers render all elements more consistently and in line with modern standards. It precisely targets only the styles that need normalizing.

http://necolas.github.io/normalize.css

- Preserves useful defaults, unlike many CSS resets.
- Normalizes styles for a wide range of elements.

- Corrects bugs and common browser inconsistencies.
- Improves usability with subtle improvements.
- Explains what code does using detailed comments.

5.8 Main Style Sheets Notes

More info here: https://github.com/h5bp/html5-boilerplate/blob/v4.3.0/doc/css.md

A couple of useful styles:

- Add the .hidden class to any elements that you want to hide from all presentations, including screen readers.
- Add the .visuallyhidden class to hide text from browsers but make it available for screen readers.
- Add the .invisible class to any element you want to hide without affecting layout

USEFUL INFO on accessibility issues...

- http://webaim.org/techniques/css/invisiblecontent/
- http://snook.ca/archives/html_and_css/hiding-content-for-accessibility

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5.9 Font Awesome

Icon font used instead of images throughout the site.

http://fortawesome.github.io/Font-Awesome/icons/

- Easy CSS control – colour, size, shadow etc.
- Scalable to any size
- Perfect for retina displays
- Wont trip up screenreaders like other icon fonts

5.10 Google CDN for jQuery

The Google CDN version of the jQuery JavaScript library is referenced towards the bottom of the page using a protocol-independent path. A local fallback of jQuery is included for rare instances when the CDN version might not be available, and to facilitate offline development.

Users may already have this version cached in their browsers, and Google's CDN is likely to deliver the asset faster than your server.

5.11 Plugin.js

This file will be used to contain all our plugins when the template gets optimised for download speeds (this will be a future development).

5.12 Foundation Framework

foundation.min.js

See the 'Elements' page of the html template to see some of the functionality that we have at our fingertips.

(It's stylesheet is put above the others so that any styles you don't want can be easily over-ridden in the mobile, tablet and desktop stylesheets, as they come after)

http://foundation.zurb.com/index.php/

5.13 Sidr – Slide-In Navigation Bar

Side Responsive Navigation (used on mobile and tablet versions of site) – more info: http://www.berriart.com/sidr/

5.14 Fit Text

FitText makes font-sizes flexible. It is used to achieve scalable headlines that fill the width of a parent element.

http://fittextjs.com/

5.16 Backstretch

Allows you to add a dynamically-resized, slideshow-capable background image to any page or element. Images are fetched after your page is loaded, so users won't have to wait for the (often large) image to download before using your site.

http://srobbin.com/jquery-plugins/backstretch/
